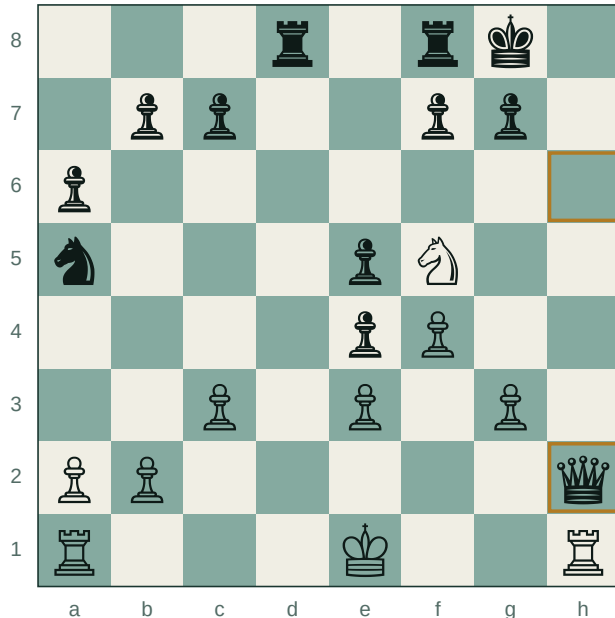


# Anastasia mating nets: White, move 25

Anastasia mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 24...Qxh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**25. Ne7+ Kh7 26. Rxh2#**

**25.Ne7+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **25...Kh7**.

**26.Rxh2#** Mate: rook on h2 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on a5 and queen on h2. Check for tactical protection.